

Key Definitions

- **Cognizant U.S. Bench:** Deployable pool of Associates not deployed to any project.
- **Covered Associates:** Associates currently on Cognizant U.S. Bench and governed by Cognizant's U.S. Bench policy timeline, commonly referred to as the [ADP \(Associate Deployable Pool\) Policy](#).
- **Covered Position:** A Covered Position is a Service Order (SO) raised in Cognizant U.S. It is an open qualified demand raised against a new or backfill position for a technical role in the United States.
- **Talent Market Place (TMP):** TMP is Cognizant's internal bench deployment tool.
- **Posting Period:** A period of one (1) week when the Covered Position is open for Covered Associates via the Talent Market Place.
- **Talent Supply Chain (TSC):** Cognizant's internal staffing team.

Objective

Cognizant strives to fill open positions by drawing from internal candidates who are on the bench and who possess the desired skill sets. Cognizant also expects its associates to be flexible and open to available roles presented to them.

Scope

The Bench Deployment Policy applies to Covered Associates on the payroll of Cognizant Technology Solutions U.S. Corporation (henceforth referred to as "Cognizant") and Covered Positions.

This Policy does not apply to individuals hired by Cognizant as contractors or through third-party vendors, or to commercial, corporate, or leadership positions; fixed-term employees or part-time positions; or employees of newly acquired entities who have not yet transitioned to the Cognizant U.S. Bench policy.

Guiding Principles

- Cognizant shall evaluate all qualified Covered Associates for Covered Positions to determine if they meet the requirements for the role. Covered Associates are deemed eligible for consideration if they:
 - Possess the required skill sets for the role or base skills where cross-skilling is possible;
 - Possess relevant experience or meet the career-level requirement for the role;
 - Have a satisfactory performance rating and project roll-off feedback, and are not on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP);
 - Are in good standing at the time of the evaluation; and
 - Are available for staffing.
- Subject to certain exceptions, Cognizant will not interview external candidates for any Covered Positions until Cognizant has evaluated, and, if appropriate, selected eligible, qualified, and interested Covered Associates; and/or the position has been open to Covered Associates via the Talent Market Place for the Posting Period.
- Covered Associates who have applied or been recommended for an opportunity will undergo assessments based on, among other things, their skill sets and previous project experience. It is the responsibility of the Covered Associates to work with their TSC point of contact on staffing, including preparation, assessments, and deployment.

Posting Period Exceptions

In certain instances, Cognizant may deem it necessary to open the Covered Positions for external hiring before the expiry of the one (1) week Posting Period for bench deployment because of specific client requests that otherwise cannot be met. This may include, but is not limited to, scenarios in which:

- The demand is high and there are very few Covered Associates on the Cognizant U.S. Bench for a specified skill at the point in time when the Covered Position is flagged for external hiring. In such a scenario, Cognizant will continue looking at all fulfillment channels in parallel to align with the demand magnitude.
- The demand is for a niche skill that Cognizant does not have internally and it is imperative to hire externally.
- The demand is for a specific combination of technical and domain skills, or specific experience(s) that Cognizant's existing Covered Associates do not possess.
- The demand is because of rebadging activities arising out of a merger or acquisition or a client rebadging request.
- The demand entails hiring contract/temporary labor for a specific requirement.

Cognizant reserves the right to amend its policies as necessary. Any changes to the Bench Deployment Policy will be approved by the Head of HR Operations.

Version History

Revision Date	Description of Change
Nov 30, 2020	Initial version

Policy Control Information

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Policy Owner: Felix Weitzman

Department: Human Resources
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